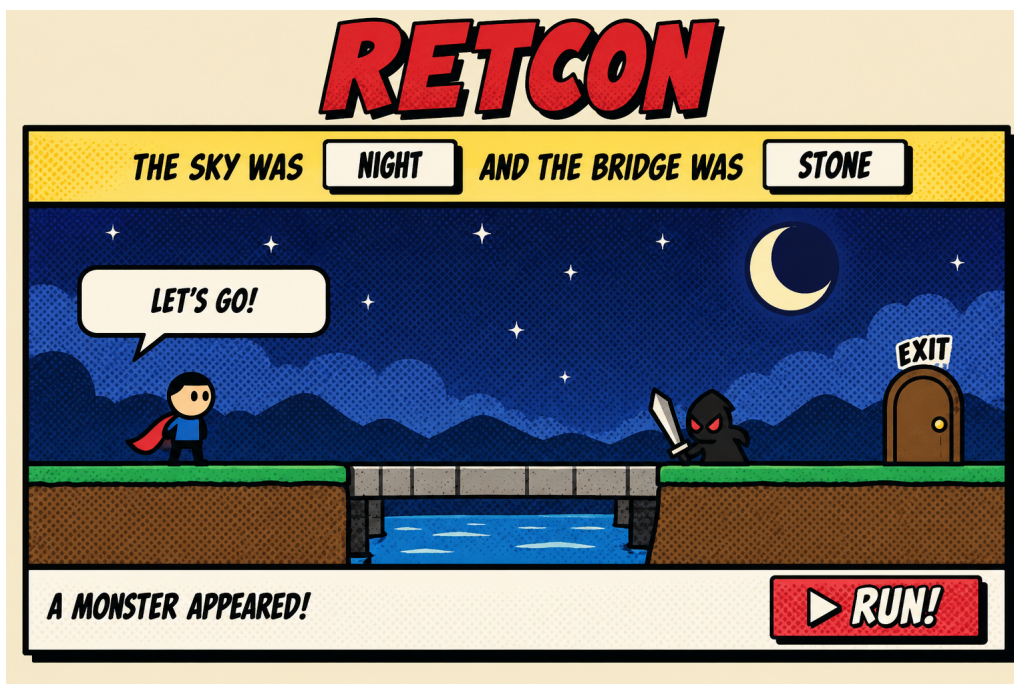
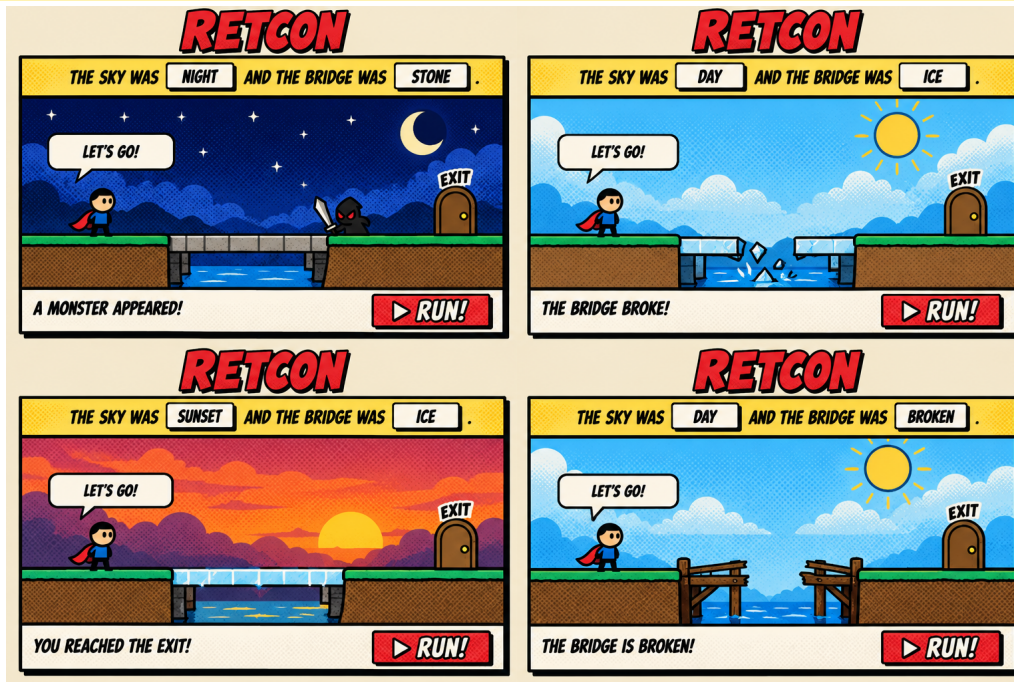


RETCON

Team APEX • Game Jam: Comic + Twist + Light

One-line pitch: RETCON is a comic-book puzzle-platformer where the narration captions are your controls. Swap the words of the story, such as NIGHT to DAY, and the world rewrites itself so you can reach the exit.



1. Concept

The hero lives inside a comic page. Each level begins with a narrator caption like "The sky was [NIGHT] and the bridge was [BROKEN]." The words in brackets are swappable. The player clicks a word to cycle through alternatives, and the level changes instantly. Then the player runs and jumps to the exit.

The player doesn't fight the villain. They edit the story until the villain can't win.

2. How we use each theme

Theme	Implementation
Comic	The whole game is a comic page: panel borders, thick ink outlines, halftone shading, caption boxes, speech bubbles, and "POW! / BAM!" sound-effect text. The caption box is the main control interface, so the comic style is part of the gameplay.
Light	Light is a word the player can rewrite: NIGHT / DAY / SUNSET. Night spawns shadow beasts, day melts them and melts ice platforms, and sunset turns long shadows into harmless, walkable platforms. Light changes how the world behaves.
Twist	Swapping a word twists the story. Each level also has a narrator twist: mid-level, the caption rewrites one of its own words and the player must re-edit quickly. The final level reveals that the narrator is the villain.

3. Core gameplay loop

1. Read the caption and look at the level.
2. Click bracketed words to rewrite the world; the world reacts instantly.
3. Run and jump to the exit door.
4. The narrator twist triggers, and the player adapts.
5. Reach the exit to turn the page to the next level.

Controls: A/D or arrow keys to move, Space to jump, mouse to click words, R to restart.

4. Rule system

Every word is a tag (dark, ice, stone, asleep, etc.), and every object reacts to tags with simple rules. For example, ice + day → melts and shadow + day → dissolves. One rule engine drives every level, so new levels only need new tag combinations.

Example puzzle: "The sky was [NIGHT/DAY/SUNSET] and the bridge was [BROKEN/ICE/STONE]."

Solutions: STONE + DAY, STONE + SUNSET, or ICE + SUNSET. ICE + DAY melts the bridge, and NIGHT summons a beast.

5. Scope

Levels: 10–12 short levels (about 1 minute each), plus a final boss-twist level.

Words: about 10 (time of day, bridge, guard, weather, plant, etc.).

Target playtime: 10–15 minutes.

Win / lose: reach the exit to win; falling, being caught, or the narrator twist undoing your edit means retry (instant restart).

Prototype: a working HTML mockup already exists, showing word swapping, the light changes, and the comic style.

6. Technology

HTML5 + JavaScript with Phaser 3 (Arcade Physics), bundled with Vite. Hosted on GitHub Pages / itch.io, and runs in any browser. Git + GitHub for collaboration.

7. Art and audio plan

Art: flat colors, thick black outlines, halftone dot overlays, hand-drawn style caption boxes and bubbles (SVG/PNG). A limited palette changes with the light word.

Audio: jsfxr/Bfxr sound effects, a short looping jazzy/noir track, and comic-style sound effect pop-ups.

Juice: screen shake on word swaps, panel “page turn” transitions, and particles when the world rewrites.

8. Team

The team is composed of three members with responsibilities across programming, level design, UI, art, audio, deployment, and documentation.

Name	Role
Sai Ram (Team Leader)	Lead programmer: core gameplay, tag/rule engine, repo
Sri Vignesh Arya	Level design, UI (caption/word system), playtesting
Jaswanth Charry	Art, audio, itch.io page, proposal/README

9. Timeline (100 hours)

Hours	Milestone
0-10	Repo setup, Phaser project, player movement, first word-swap level
10-30	Tag/rule engine, 4 playable levels, core fun-check
30-55	All words and levels, narrator twist, final level
55-75	Final art, audio, UI polish, juice; feature freeze at hour ~60
75-90	Playtesting, balancing, bug fixing
90-100	Deploy, cover image, description, buffer

10. Risks and mitigation

Level design is hard: reserve about 20 hours for it and playtest early.

Scope creep: cap the word list at about 10, with a feature freeze at hour 60.

Unclear puzzles: speech-bubble hints and instant restart keep the game friendly.

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